

Leif Hellgren

New York City | (949) 943-9847 | leif@exelor.com | linkedin.com/in/leif-hellgren-a1177216a | leif-hellgren1.github.io | github.com/leif-hellgren1

SUMMARY

Built the outbound engine and CRM for a startup from scratch, using LLMs to personalize outreach that booked 4 qualified meetings in a week. Before that I owned a flight-critical subsystem on Blue Origin's lunar lander end to end. I also build my own Python and LLM tools for algorithmic trading. Now looking to move into GTM full time, both the outbound work and the tooling behind it.

EXPERIENCE

Responsible Engineer, Flight-Critical Cryogenic Fluid Management System (Lunar Lander) | Blue Origin

June 2022 - November 2024 | El Segundo, CA

- Owned a flight-critical propellant tank pressure management subsystem on Blue Origin's first lunar lander end to end, using a thermodynamic venting approach to manage tank pressure in microgravity where traditional venting was not viable.
- Designed the restrictor, latch valve, and heater assembly, and built a first-principles fluid model to size components and drive design decisions ahead of formal analysis.
- Owned design of a large cryogenic tubing assembly for LH2 and LOx routed through a constrained vehicle environment, reducing system mass while meeting flow, structural, and thermal requirements.
- Led the subsystem FMECA and an independent hydrogen accumulation and ignition risk analysis for off-nominal conditions, and the mitigations went into the vehicle design.
- Defined test requirements and procedures, designed test rigs, and coordinated with vendors through development, acceptance, and qualification testing.
- Coordinated with thermal, GNC, structures, manufacturing, integration, safety, and test throughout, and owned the subsystem's drawings, releases, BOMs, and P&ID.
- Selected vendors, wrote specs, and managed fabrication and delivery schedules for the subsystem.
- Addressed the subsystem in its entirety at PDR, CDR, and TRR.

Independent Developer, Python & LLM Systems | Self-Employed

November 2024 - Present

- Built a Python and LLM automation stack for algorithmic trading, including a scanner, staged alerting, and backtesting tools.
- Built an outreach automation system that researches target accounts and drafts personalized outreach copy using an LLM.
- Actively building an iOS app with an integrated LLM assistant built into the core experience.

Founder | Aerospace Research Cooperative, UC Santa Barbara

2017-2021

- Founded UCSB's first aerospace organization and collaborated with the university's Experimental Cosmology Lab.

Co-Founder & Lead Propulsion Feed System Engineer | UCSB Rocket Propulsion Laboratory

2017-2021

- Co-founded what became the university's largest engineering organization and an approved senior capstone project, and led the design of a methalox engine feed system.

PROJECTS

Growth Consultant | Launchpoint

June - July 2026

Case study: building the outbound motion and CRM from scratch (read [here](#))

- Built the company's first CRM in Attio from scratch in a few days.
- Built the outbound motion from nothing and secured 4 qualified meetings in one week.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's in Physics | University of California, Santa Barbara

2017-2021

SKILLS

Sales & GTM: cold email and LinkedIn outbound, Apollo, AI-assisted prospecting and personalization at volume, CRM implementation (Attio), pipeline design, task automation

Engineering: systems engineering, mechanical design, fluid and thermal analysis, first-principles modeling, FMECA and risk analysis, vendor management

Software & Data: Python (Pandas, Streamlit), TypeScript/Next.js, SQL, Git